English • Education, evidence and literary evaluation

Quality Education

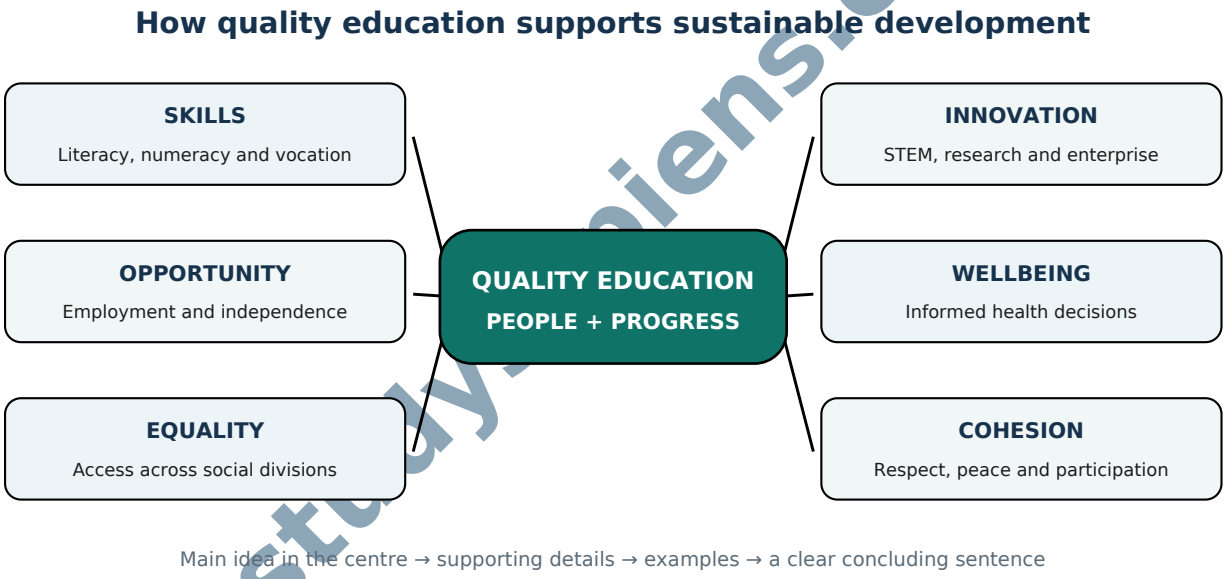
A Key to Success • Official activities • SDGs • Phrases • Role-play • Two book reviews

Unit 9 • Complete official activities • SDGs + Phrases + Role-Play + Book Reviews

Text at a glance

• **Quality education:** A holistic process developing knowledge, practical skills, values and attitudes for productive, fulfilling and responsible lives.
• **SDG 4:** Inclusive, equitable quality education and lifelong learning opportunities for all.
• **Wider impact:** Human capital, employment, innovation, gender equality, health, social cohesion, peace and sustainable development.
• **Language focus:** Evidence and inference, SDG connections, eyewitness perspective, context clues, phrases, role-play and book reviewing.

Figure 1 — Original education-to-development impact map



Main idea in the centre → supporting details → examples → a clear concluding sentence

Quality means more than attendance: Safe and inclusive access must be joined with relevant curricula, trained and supported teachers, effective learning, practical skills and fair outcomes.

Pre-Reading and While-Reading

P1. What is quality education, and why is it important for national development?

Quality education enables learners to acquire useful knowledge, think critically, act ethically and apply skills in real life. It develops human capital, innovation and informed citizenship while reducing avoidable inequality. A country benefits when more people can contribute productively and participate responsibly in social and democratic life.

Margin questions. Quick answers in passage order.

Question	Answer
How does quality education empower individuals?	It builds literacy, numeracy, digital and vocational skills, confidence and knowledge, enabling people to realize their potential, gain independence and participate actively in society.
Which skills help break the cycle of poverty?	Literacy, numeracy, digital literacy, vocational skills, critical thinking and problem-solving improve employability, income opportunities and economic independence.
What does STEM stand for?	Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics.
Which issues undermine education systems?	Outdated curricula and pedagogy, teacher shortages, low salaries, inadequate professional training, unequal access and insufficient resources or support.

Reading and Critical Thinking

A. Answer the following questions.

1. How is quality education defined in the text?

It is education that takes a holistic approach, equipping learners with the knowledge, skills, values and attitudes needed to thrive in a rapidly changing world. It supports productive and fulfilling lives and links individual development with sustainable development, not merely examination success or years spent in school.

2. Name three benefits of quality education.

Any three are valid: it promotes economic growth, reduces poverty, advances gender equality, strengthens social cohesion, encourages peaceful conflict resolution, improves health awareness and drives innovation. Each benefit arises because education increases people’s capabilities and opportunities rather than simply providing information.

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3. Why is human capital development important for growth and sustainability?

Human capital consists of the knowledge, skills and health people accumulate and use to contribute to development. Quality education strengthens these capacities, making workers more adaptable, productive and innovative. A healthier, skilled population can create enterprises, conduct research and respond to changing needs without relying only on finite natural resources.

4. Describe education’s role in reducing inequality and poverty.

Equitable education gives marginalized learners capabilities and qualifications that improve access to employment and income. It acts as a leveller when opportunities are not restricted by wealth, gender or ethnicity. Vocational and digital skills support independence, while inclusive access challenges inherited disadvantage. These gains require affordable, safe and genuinely effective provision, not access alone.

5. How does quality education promote understanding and tolerance?

It introduces different cultures, religions and perspectives, encouraging learners to question prejudice and understand root causes of conflict. Inclusive schools bring diverse groups together around a shared purpose. Literacy and critical thinking support informed discussion, while empathy and democratic participation help people resolve disagreements peacefully.

6. How can teaching entrepreneurship promote economic growth?

Entrepreneurship education helps learners identify needs, evaluate risks, manage resources and develop innovative products or services. New enterprises can create employment and increase productivity, while problem-solving skills also benefit existing organizations. Ethical guidance is important so that enterprise contributes to communities rather than pursuing profit without responsibility.

7. Why is STEM education important for innovation?

STEM develops technical knowledge, curiosity and a systematic problem-solving mindset. Learners test ideas, interpret evidence and design solutions, abilities needed for scientific discovery and technological advancement. Universities extend this foundation by providing researchers, laboratories and collaboration for research and development.

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8. How could education quality improve in your school or community?

Model response: Our school could begin with a learning survey, then provide targeted reading support, teacher workshops and reliable access to books and digital resources. Classes could include more practical problem-solving and regular constructive feedback. A community library and mentoring programme could support learners who lack study space at home. Progress should be measured through attendance, inclusion and demonstrated learning, not only through new equipment.

B. Choose the correct options.

Q	Answer
1	(a) by fostering economic growth, reducing poverty and promoting gender equality
2	(d) focus on sports and entertainment — not listed as the named benefit
3	(b) mathematics, science and technology
4	(b) literacy, numeracy and digital literacy
5	(c) by encouraging critical thinking
6	(b) strengthens communities
7	(b) technical skills for innovation
8	(b) provide resources and an environment for research

C. Identify two additional SDGs and explain their connection with education quality.

Goal 1. No Poverty

Poverty can force children into work and prevent families from affording transport, uniforms, connectivity or study materials. Scholarships, school meals and targeted support can improve attendance and concentration. In turn, quality education develops skills that improve future earning opportunities, creating a two-way relationship between poverty reduction and learning.

Goal 5. Gender Equality

Safe, inclusive schools and equal expectations help girls remain in education and pursue leadership, STEM and vocational pathways. Female teachers and fair policies can increase participation where communities value visible role models. Educated women gain greater independence and can challenge discriminatory expectations, while gender-sensitive education teaches all learners to respect equal dignity.

Concise unit summary

• Quality education develops knowledge, values and practical abilities needed for individual fulfilment and sustainable development. It strengthens human capital, employment, gender equality, health, innovation and social cohesion while helping reduce poverty and prejudice. STEM, entrepreneurship and higher-education research support technological and economic progress. Outdated curricula, unequal access and inadequately supported teachers remain major obstacles. Curriculum reform, professional development, inclusion and coordinated investment are therefore essential to make SDG 4 meaningful for every learner.

Evidence and Perspective

D. Analyse the eyewitness account of education reforms.

Facts and details. How does the writer present the reforms?

The writer uses a dated, located first-person account and direct observation: renovated classrooms, colourful posters, modern tools, new textbooks and interactive lessons. Quotations from Ms. Kiran, Zaaraa and Mr. Zeeshaan supply teacher and student viewpoints. Details are concrete rather than merely general, and the writer also records overcrowding, limited technology and unequal rural resources.

Tone and perspective. What tone is used, and how does personal perspective influence the account?

The tone is hopeful and impressed but cautiously balanced. Phrases such as “excited chatter”, “proudly” and “truly changed” convey enthusiasm, whereas “not everything was perfect” and “a long way to go” preserve concern. The writer’s final judgement of a positive impact is limited to an urban school observed on one day, so it should not be generalized to every rural institution without broader evidence.

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E. Impactful words and phrases in paragraphs 1, 2, 3 and 10.

Paragraph	High-impact language and effect
1	“essential for sustainable development”, “holistic approach”, “thrive”, “unlock the potential” — presents education as comprehensive and future-shaping.
2	“critical thinking”, “problem-solving”, “high demand”, “innovation and productivity” — connects classroom learning with workforce capability.

Paragraph	High-impact language and effect
3	“powerful tool for empowerment”, “realize their full potential”, “social justice”, “economic independence” — emphasizes agency and equality.
10	“fuels innovation and creativity”, “lift … out of poverty”, “informed decisions”, “strengthens communities” — links enterprise, health and shared wellbeing.

Vocabulary: Contextual Clues

A. Contextual meanings and synonyms of the highlighted words.

Word	Contextual meaning	Synonym(s)
bustling	full of busy activity	busy, lively
aromatic	having a pleasant, noticeable smell	fragrant, scented
vibrant	bright and full of life	vivid, lively
energy	physical and mental vigour	vitality, vigour
resilience	ability to endure and recover from difficulty	toughness, perseverance
serene	calm and peaceful	tranquil, composed
hustle	busy, hurried activity	bustle, commotion

B. Complete each sentence using context clues.

1. **bustling** city of Lahore

2. **aromatic** dish

3. **vibrant** colours

4. great **resilience**

5. a **serene** spot by the lake

6. a lot of **energy** during sports day

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Grammar: Adjectival, Prepositional and Adverbial Phrases

Key distinction: *Prepositional* describes a phrase's form (preposition + complement). *Adjectival* and *adverbial* describe its function. A prepositional phrase can therefore be adjectival or adverbial.

A. Identify and label phrases in the Greenfield passage.

Phrase	Type and function
in the quiet village	prepositional + adverbial: where the girl lived
of Greenfield	prepositional + adjectival: describes "village"
with bright blue eyes	prepositional + adjectival: describes "girl"
with her grandmother	prepositional + adverbial: tells with whom she lived
Every morning	adverbial noun phrase: when she walked
to the nearby forest	prepositional + adverbial: direction
in search of flowers	prepositional + adverbial: purpose of walking
to find daisies	infinitive phrase with adjectival force: explains the favourite place's purpose
under the old oak tree	prepositional + adverbial: location after "was"
near the stream	prepositional + adjectival: identifies which oak tree
Despite the early hour	prepositional + adverbial: concession
full of energy and enthusiasm	adjectival phrase describing the girl; "of …" completes "full"
to do her daily household work	infinitive phrase completing "enthusiasm": what she was enthusiastic to do

B. Expand the sentences with suitable phrases.

Expanded model sentence	Added phrase(s) and label
The children **from our neighbourhood** played **in the garden after school**.	adjectival; prepositional/adverbial place and time

Expanded model sentence	Added phrase(s) and label
He completed the task **with great care before the deadline**.	adverbial manner and time
They went on vacation **to the northern areas during summer**.	adverbial place and time
The teacher **with years of experience** explained the math problem **in a patient voice**.	adjectival; adverbial manner
They attended the wedding **at the community hall with their cousins**.	adverbial place and accompaniment
The family celebrated Eid **with their relatives in their ancestral home**.	adverbial accompaniment and place
He completed his homework **with full concentration before dinner**.	adverbial manner and time
The students presented their projects **on climate change confidently in the school hall**.	adjectival topic phrase; adverbial manner and place

Oral Communication: “The Power of Education”

Role-play. Perform three scenes: struggle → call for change → impact.

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Completed performance script

• **Scene 1 — The Struggle to Learn**

Student A: “How can we learn when we do not have proper textbooks?”

Student B: “Our classroom is so crowded that the teacher cannot help everyone.”

Teacher: “Without enough resources and training, it is difficult to give every learner effective support.”

• **Scene 2 — The Call for Change**

Community Leader: “We need safe classrooms, qualified teachers and updated resources for every child.”

Government Official: “We will assess local needs, train teachers and monitor whether resources actually improve learning.”

Student B: “Please include students in the feedback so that the plan responds to our real difficulties.”

• **Scene 3 — The Impact**

Student A: “We now have books and supervised digital activities that make difficult ideas clearer.”

Teacher: “The new training helps me use interactive lessons and identify learners who need extra support.”

Community Leader: “These changes matter because more students are participating and demonstrating learning.”

• **All together:** “Quality education is the key to success!”

Performance guidance: Scene 1 should sound concerned rather than hopeless; Scene 2 should be purposeful and respectful; Scene 3 should convey measured pride. The added monitoring and student-feedback lines prevent the role-play from suggesting that equipment alone guarantees quality.

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Writing Skills: Book Reviews

Required review: Little Women by Louisa May Alcott, retold by John Escott — 200–300 words.

Model review — Little Women

• *Little Women*, written by Louisa May Alcott and retold by John Escott, is a coming-of-age domestic novel set in Massachusetts during the American Civil War. It follows Meg, Jo, Beth and Amy March as they face limited money, personal ambitions and changing family responsibilities while their father is away.

• The plot moves through the sisters' friendships, mistakes, creative projects and acts of generosity. Their neighbour Laurie adds companionship and new experiences, but the heart of the book remains the sisters' growth. Each girl must learn that maturity involves more than getting what she wants.

• Jo is especially memorable because she is outspoken, imaginative and determined to write. Her impatience and quick temper create conflict, yet she gradually learns self-control without losing her independence. Amy provides an effective contrast: her early vanity and desire for admiration can be irritating, but her experiences encourage greater awareness of others.

• Major themes include family loyalty, personal growth, work, generosity and the struggle to define independence. The March sisters differ greatly, but their affection allows them to challenge and support one another. Alcott's warm, descriptive and emotionally direct style makes domestic events feel significant; Escott's accessible retelling helps new readers follow the classic.

• I found the moral lessons occasionally obvious, but the sincerity of the family relationships kept them engaging. I would recommend this book to readers who enjoy character-centred stories, sisterhood and hopeful accounts of growing up, particularly those approaching the classic for the first time.

A. Review a book of your choice using the same components.

Additional model — The Old Man and the Sea

• *The Old Man and the Sea* by Ernest Hemingway is a short novel about Santiago, an ageing Cuban fisherman who has gone many days without a catch. Far out at sea, he hooks a huge marlin and begins a demanding struggle that tests his strength, patience and judgement. His bond with the boy Manolin adds warmth and reminds us that dignity does not exclude dependence on others.

• Santiago is compelling because he is proud but not arrogant. He respects the fish and understands the sea, yet he must confront the limits of age and endurance. His persistence can appear heroic and painfully stubborn at the same time, giving the story moral complexity.

• The central themes are perseverance, dignity, solitude, respect for nature and the difference between outward loss and inner defeat. Hemingway's style is economical: simple vocabulary, concrete action and repeated details carry deeper symbolic meaning. The descriptions of physical effort make the struggle vivid without needing elaborate commentary.

• I admired the novel's restraint and the tenderness between Santiago and Manolin. Readers seeking a fast, event-filled plot may find parts slow, but those pauses reveal character. I would recommend it to students who enjoy reflective adventure stories and discussions about whether success should be measured by results, effort or self-respect.

Original Exam-Practice MCQs

1. SDG 4 concerns:

(a) quality education (b) clean energy
(c) life below water (d) zero hunger

Answer: (a) quality education — It promotes inclusive, equitable education and lifelong learning.

2. Human capital includes:

(a) knowledge, skills and health (b) only buildings
(c) only money (d) natural minerals

Answer: (a) knowledge, skills and health — These human capacities support productivity and development.

3. Which skill is vocational rather than purely theoretical?

(a) a job-related practical skill (b) a memorized date only
(c) an unrelated slogan (d) a rhyme scheme

Answer: (a) a job-related practical skill — Vocational learning connects with occupational practice.

4. Inclusive education can promote cohesion by:

(a) separating every group (b) bringing diverse learners into shared purpose
(c) discouraging empathy (d) avoiding discussion

Answer: (b) bringing diverse learners into shared purpose — Belonging and mutual respect reduce divisions.

5. STEM stands for:

(a) Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (b) Society, Trade, Economy and Media
(c) Sports, Theatre, English and Music (d) Skills, Tests, Exams and Marks

Answer: (a) Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics — These fields support technical innovation.

6. An eyewitness account is strengthened by:

(a) specific observations and attributed quotations (b) hidden sources and vague claims
(c) no date or location (d) personal opinion alone

Answer: (a) specific observations and attributed quotations — Concrete detail helps readers assess the account.

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7. “With bright blue eyes” functions as:

(a) an adjectival phrase (b) an independent clause
(c) a verb phrase only (d) a coordinating conjunction

Answer: (a) an adjectival phrase — It describes the girl.

8. “Every morning” functions as:

(a) an adverbial time phrase (b) a direct object
(c) a dependent clause (d) a preposition

Answer: (a) an adverbial time phrase — It tells when the action occurred.

9. A book review should combine:

(a) summary, analysis, evaluation and recommendation (b) only the ending
(c) only a list of characters (d) personal attacks on the author

Answer: (a) summary, analysis, evaluation and recommendation — It informs and supports a judgement.

10. Which is the fairest review judgement?

(a) praise every feature without evidence (b) identify strengths and limitations with examples
(c) reveal every surprise (d) reject a book because it is old

Answer: (b) identify strengths and limitations with examples — Balanced evidence makes evaluation credible.

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Points to Remember

Quality education: holistic learning, values and usable skills in inclusive, safe and effective settings.

Development links: human capital, employment, innovation, health, equality and social cohesion.

Obstacles: outdated curricula, unequal access and shortages or inadequate support for teachers.

SDG connections: progress in poverty reduction and gender equality can remove barriers to learning.

Phrase analysis: distinguish grammatical form from sentence function.

Eyewitness analysis: separate observed detail, quoted testimony and the writer's interpretation.

Book review: introduction → spoiler-aware summary → characters/themes/style → evidence-based opinion → recommendation.

MCQ key at a glance

Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key	Q	Key
1	a	2	a	3	a	4	b	5	a
6	a	7	a	8	a	9	a	10	b

How to attempt this unit in the paper

- For education questions, connect each claimed benefit to a mechanism such as skills, inclusion or informed choices.
- Do not generalize one urban eyewitness visit to all schools; acknowledge scope and perspective.
- When labelling a prepositional phrase, state both its form and whether it describes a noun or modifies an action.
- In a review, avoid revealing the ending unless the task explicitly requests it.
- Support praise or criticism with a specific character, event or stylistic feature rather than repeating "interesting".